nowned fashion houses, participating in major fashion weeks, or having made significant contributions to fashion publications

Look for institutions **accredited by QS I-Gauge**, a private sector initiative for rating educational institutions, and the only one rating design institutions, in India. Accreditation ensures that the programme meets certain quality standards and follows industry-relevant curriculum

Successful alumni and strong industry connections indicate a programme's quality and its network. Aspirants should look for **information on internships, placements and alumni success stories**—graduates who have gone on to work with top designers, started their own labels, or held significant positions in fashion companies

Institutions with strong industry connections often have tie-ups with fashion houses, retail brands and design firms. Check for these

State-of-the-art facilities and resources are crucial for a comprehensive learning experience. Visit the institution campus and look out for **modern design studios, well-equipped labs, and access to the latest design software**. The equipment should not only be there but also showing signs of "use" by the students. An institution with advanced patternmaking, 3D visualisation and 3D printing facilities and a well-stocked library can enhance the learning experience

The **quality of student work** reflects the programme's strength. Seek out institutions that regularly showcase student work and have a track record of participating in major fashion events. If a school doesn't prominently display student achievements or lacks participation in such events, it may not provide the competitive edge needed in the industry

TOP 10 COLLEGES WITH BEST VALUE FOR MONEY

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	ROI*
1	HANS RAJ MAHILA MAHA VIDYALAYA	Jalandhar	2.48
2	SRI KRISHNA ARTS AND SCIENCE COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Coimbatore	1.52
3	KANYA MAHA VIDYALAYA (AUTONOMOUS)	Jalandhar	1.44
4	BISHOP APPASAMY COLLEGE OF ARTS AND SCIENCE	Coimbatore	1.31
5	BBK DAV COLLEGE FOR WOMEN	Amritsar	1.30
6	PSG COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCE	Coimbatore	1.27
7	NEHRU ARTS AND SCIENCE COLLEGE	Coimbatore	1.21
8	PUNJAB COLLEGE OF TECHNICAL EDUCATION	Ludhiana	1.15
9	FASHION & APPAREL DESIGN, T. JOHN COLLEGE	Bengaluru	1.07
10	NIFT-TEA COLLEGE OF KNITWEAR FASHION	Tirupur, TN	0.91

**ROI (return on investment) is calculated based on average annual salary/ total course fee (entire duration)*

NEW-AGE COURSES

By Antonio Maurizio Grioli,
Dean, Fashion, Business, Interiors (FBI), Pearl Academy, Delhi

Sustainable fashion design: A cornerstone of modern fashion education, it reflects awareness of environmental issues, teaching students eco-friendly practices, ethical sourcing and use of sustainable materials

Digital fashion design: By pursuing a course in digital fashion and 3D design, students dive into CAD [computer-aided design], 3D pattern-making and digital portfolio development. They get to work on digital garment simulations and virtual fashion shows using tools like CLO 3D and Adobe Illustrator

Fashion business or entrepreneurship: India's luxury market is projected to grow to $90 billion by 2030 (according to a report by global management consultancy firm Bain & Company), increasing the demand for experts in the luxury brand management. Specialised BBA and MBA programmes in fashion business teach skills in brand strategy, omnichannel retailing and direct-to-consumer models

Fashion communication and fashion styling: These are comprehensive courses that delve into aspects of brand management, digital marketing, public relations and fashion journalism. Students of fashion communication learn how to effectively communicate on fashion concepts, products, and brands. Fashion styling programmes, on the other hand, teach students the art of storytelling through clothing and accessories. They learn to curate